

PHOTOSHOP · MULTIMEDIA 12 · SPRINT 4 · LESSONS 1-4 · LIGHTING WITH ADJUSTMENTS AND MASKS

LAST LIGHT.

Design the superhero movie poster for a film that doesn't exist yet. Put a hero (the starter photo, or you) into a new world, light them with adjustment layers and masks, and then your director moves the light.

15 illustrated stages

Four lessons (one advanced)

Scenario: film poster studio

Curves · masks · rim light · atmosphere · type · motion



Demo key art built in Photoshop from the class hero image and a free-licence city photo (Erik Mclean, Pexels). Your hero, film and credits are your own.

Teacher review edition · repaired 9 October 2026

Text, assessment boundaries, recall and navigation have been repaired. This remains a Draft: complete manual Photoshop verification, action-by-action captures, genuine mistake pairs, rendered motion review and an independent cold run are pending.

Submission: the existing project Knowledge + Reflection Form is linked below. Earlier connection receipts are retained; current school-account accepting state and revised outcome/rubric bindings remain unverified. Journal controls prepare a handoff; they do not submit evidence. No fresh dashboard synchronization is claimed.

STUDIO BRIEF

Key art for a film called LAST LIGHT (or your own title).

A small production company needs a poster and a 5-second motion teaser for an everyday-hero film. The story: when the city goes dark, one person does not. The audience is teens and adults. The producer's rule: **a green primary blast drives the baseline image. The extension adds a weaker warm source from the opposite side and a small bright chest emitter. Plan every source; each highlight must have a reason.**

You will hand in

- Light plan (thumbnail with source and arrows)
- Poster A and poster B (after the director moves the light) as JPG
- 5-second teaser MP4
- Layered PSD with named groups: MOOD, LIGHT, FIGURE, ATMOSPHERE, TYPE
- Three-sentence explanation of the relight

Rules

- Original hero only: invent your own. No existing characters, costumes, logos or film titles (they belong to someone else, and this page is public).
- Your own photos or the starter pack. You can be the hero: have a classmate photograph you in flat light. Photos of classmates only with their permission.
- Guided steps: the Coach can help with terms and tools. Practical check: your decisions only.

Knowledge + Reflection

Open this project's existing Form ↗

Use your school account. Earlier release record: 19 October 2026. Current accepting state is unverified. Your teacher releases assessment access.

INDUSTRY CONNECTION

Key art sells a film before anyone sees it.

Studios commission “key art”: the single image used on posters, streaming tiles and billboards. Designers build it in Photoshop from photographs, and they light it the way a cinematographer lights a set. Every highlight is motivated by a source the audience can believe. S1

Posters follow conventions viewers read without thinking: a title with one strong typeface, a tagline, and a condensed billing block of credits at the bottom. S2 Today most key art also ships as a motion poster.

Watch (technique)

- **Stylish highlights and realistic highlights** (Benny Productions): the core painting-light method.
- **Cinematic movie poster** (Mir Rom): mood, grade and atmosphere.
- For teacher prep or extension: Nour Art’s Spider-Man manipulation and Hazy Graphix’s Avengers remake. These are great techniques, but they use existing characters, so your poster must be original.

KNOWLEDGE FIRST

How light works, and how Photoshop fakes it.

Light obeys rules

- **Direction:** light travels in straight lines from its source. Highlights face the source; shadows point away.
- **Fall-off:** light gets dimmer with distance, so it is brightest at the source and fades smoothly.
- **Colour:** the demo uses a stylised green energy light, teal shadows and later warm accents. Physical colour temperature and a fictional green effect are different ideas.
- **Edges catch light:** the edge of a subject turned towards a source gets a rim highlight.
- **Air shows light:** fog, dust and smoke make beams and glow visible.

Design principles in a poster

Emphasis and focal point: the brightest, highest-contrast area is where the eye goes first, so put the story there.

Value contrast: a dark world makes the light read as bright. **Colour harmony:** controlled green/teal and later warm accents distinguish illuminated surfaces from the night scene. **Hierarchy in type:** title, then tagline, then credits.

The Photoshop method

Never paint light directly on the photo. Use *adjustment layers* (Curves) with *masks*: an inverted mask hides the adjustment everywhere, and a soft white brush paints it back only where light lands. Blend modes add colour (Soft Light) and glow (Screen, Color Dodge). Because it stays on layers, you can move or animate the light later.

WHAT THIS ASSESSES

Skills you will show.

Skill (registered ID)	Where you show it
Match light and colour · PS-LGT-02 · Dodge and burn · PS-LGT-01	Steps 4–8, 10–12 and the practical check (step 14)
Adjustment layers · PS-ADJ-01 · Levels and Curves · PS-TON-01	Steps 3, 4 and 9
Selections · PS-SEL-01 · Smart Objects · PS-SMO-01	Step 2
Typography · PS-TYP-01, GD-TYP-01 · Hierarchy · GD-HIE-01	Step 13
Colour · GD-COL-01 · Audience · GD-AUD-01	Steps 6 and 9; plan and explanation
Output · PS-OUT-01	Steps 9, 12 and 15 (JPG and MP4)

Primary achievement evidence: include the approved plan, distinct thumbnail alternatives and reasoned selection, editable source, observed revision and defence. the relight (step 14) and its explanation. Guided steps, supports and the guided teaser are practice and presentation, recorded separately from achievement. Sprint: mm12-26-s04.

Image and motion evidence · course alignment

Image evidence: 1.1–1.5. Motion evidence: 2.1, 2.3–2.5 only where an actual motion product is made and tested. Cultural/historical analysis of other motion graphics (2.2) remains a separate requirement. Teacher review determines achievement.

Local mappings are proposed; existing live Form/registry bindings are unchanged. An approved project rubric binding is still required.

SESSION A · LESSON 1 · MM12-26-S04-D01

Set the mood. Paint the light.

Every cinematic poster starts with one decision: where is the light coming from? Today you build the poster file, darken the world and paint light back in with a mask.

01 Read the brief and plan the light

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: This guide · a sketch page or LastLight_plan.txt

SELECT: One light source and where it sits

TOOLS / ROUTE: Thumbnail · arrow for light direction

1. Read or listen to the **theory deck**, then the film brief in Start. Invent your hero's film title and a one-line story (or use LAST LIGHT).
2. Choose your background plate: one of your own Shot on Purpose photos, or `city_photo.jpg` from the class folder. Choose your hero: the class `hero.png`, or a photo of yourself in a hero pose taken in flat, even light.
3. Decide what makes the light: a sunset, a lamp, a doorway, a torch, headlights, a window. It must be something that could really exist in the scene.
4. Draw three genuinely different 2:3 concept thumbnails for your film. Vary the visual idea or composition, not just the colour. Mark each source and its light direction.
5. Select one concept. Give an audience/design reason for choosing it and rejecting the other two; identify a trade-off. On the selected plan, circle the surfaces the light reaches.



Motivated light in a real photo: one torch explains every bright surface and the direction of every shadow.

WHY

Film lighting is *motivated*: every highlight has a believable source. When the light has a reason, the viewer believes the world.

CHECK

Three different concepts, a reasoned selection, title/story and a chosen light plan with source, arrows and lit surfaces.

FIX

Can't decide? Pick a source that is inside the frame, like a doorway or lamp. It is the easiest to make believable.

Method basis: S1. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

02 Build the poster file and cut out the figure

Procedure status · partial author run from blank. New document creation and the city placement/name/horizontal flip were performed in Photoshop 2026. Five action captures are available for this portion. Figure placement, masking and the rest of the full manual reconstruction are pending; this is not an independent cold run.

DOCUMENT: LastLight_YourName.psd · starter pack

SELECT: The plate and your figure

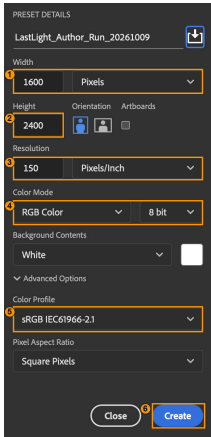
TOOLS / ROUTE: File › New · Place Embedded · Select › Subject · layer mask

1. Press Ctrl/Cmd+N. Name the file LastLight_YourName. Use Width 1600 px, Height 2400 px, Resolution 150 ppi, RGB / 8 bit, white background, sRGB and square pixels. Choose Create.
2. Choose File › Place Embedded. Select city_photo.jpg from the extracted starter pack, then click Place.
3. The supplied city photo is 2400 × 3593 pixels, with 72 ppi metadata. In this 150 ppi document, the observed Place Embedded values were X 800 px, Y 1200 px, W/H 32%, rotation 0°. Keep proportions linked. Inspect all four edges before pressing Enter: this auto-fit can leave a thin white border. A linked 32.1% fill is calculated but not yet run or captured.
4. Double-click the city layer name and enter PLATE. Select PLATE, then choose Edit › Transform › Flip Horizontal to match the demo's city orientation.
5. Figure route (not yet run in this fresh author file): File › Place Embedded, choose hero.png, and commit the placement. Preserve the Smart Object.
6. For a new photo, select the figure layer, choose Select › Subject, then Add layer mask. The class PNG already has transparency. This figure/mask route is not yet run in the fresh file.
7. The original scripted reference enlarges the auto-fitted figure by 118% relative to its initial placement and moves its centre to X 840, Y 1530. Do not enter 118% as an absolute source-image scale. Manual reproduction and control captures are pending.
8. Name it FIGURE. Check its large scale against the original reference: the hero occupies the left two thirds and the source has room on the right. Save the layered PSD; this save route still needs a fresh capture.

Action by action: real Photoshop screenshots (orange boxes show where to look), and the result

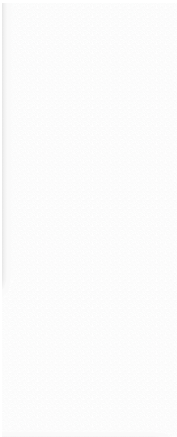
1 Create the document with the six boxed settings. This creation was run; the result crop shows the right portion of the new blank canvas before placing the city.

IN PHOTOSHOP



1 Width; 2 Height; 3 Resolution; 4 RGB/8 bit; 5 sRGB; 6 Create.

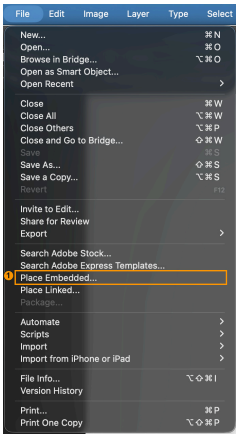
IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



Cropped right portion of the actual blank canvas. Raw capture retains the File menu opened for the next action.

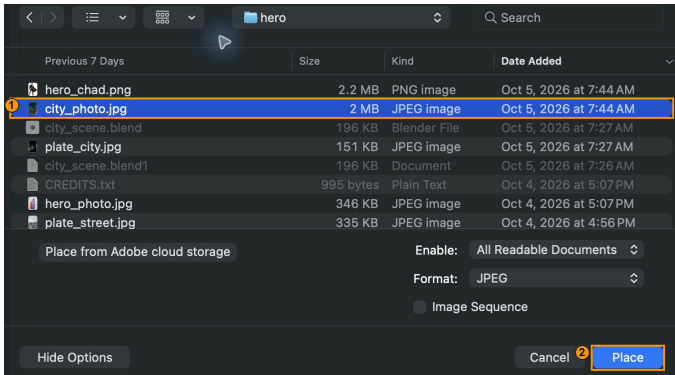
2 Open File and choose Place Embedded. This keeps the photographic source editable.

IN PHOTOSHOP



1: Place Embedded in the real open File menu.

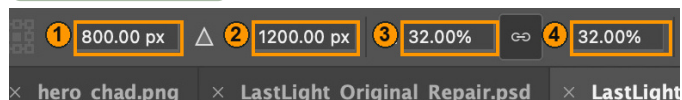
IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



The real file chooser: city_photo.jpg selected (1), Place (2).

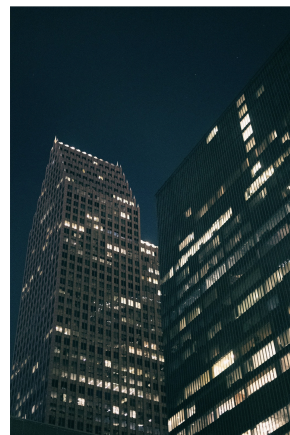
3 The fresh run showed X 800, Y 1200, W/H 32%. Check the canvas edges before committing; the fill correction is still pending. Name the resulting Smart Object **PLATE**.

IN PHOTOSHOP



1 X; 2 Y; 3 W; 4 H. Observed auto-fit values; a thin border still needs correction and a fresh capture.

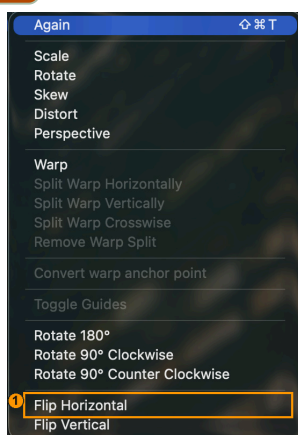
IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



Actual placement before the flip. The tallest facade is on the right; full edge coverage is not yet verified.

4 With **PLATE** selected, choose **Edit > Transform > Flip Horizontal**. This matches the orientation used in the original poster.

IN PHOTOSHOP



1: Flip Horizontal in the actual open Transform submenu.

IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



Verified flipped orientation: the tallest facade is on the left. Edge fitting and figure construction remain pending.

WHY

Smart Objects and masks keep everything editable, so you can move the light later without starting again. You will need that in the practical check.

CHECK

A 1600 × 2400 file with a **PLATE** and a masked **FIGURE**, both Smart Objects, with the light source visible beside the hero.

FIX

Select Subject missed hair? In the mask, paint black to hide and white to reveal with a soft brush. Figure looks pasted on? Wait: the next steps fix the light.

Method basis: **A2**. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

03 Set the mood: darken the whole world

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: LastLight_YourName.psd

SELECT: Everything (the adjustment sits at the top)

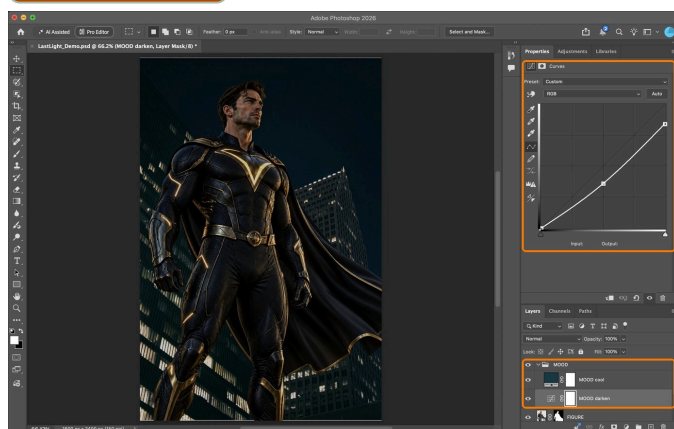
TOOLS / ROUTE: Layer › New Adjustment Layer › Curves › Solid Color

1. Click the top layer, then add a Curves adjustment layer. Name it **MOOD darken**.
2. In **MOOD darken**, use RGB curve points 0→0, 128→92 and 255→215. These are the original demo values; this complete adjustment creation route is not yet run manually.
3. Add **MOOD cool** as Solid Color #0A3C46 (RGB 10, 60, 70), Soft Light, Opacity 40%. This preserves the original teal shadows. Complete creation and capture are still pending.
4. Compare before and after by clicking the eye icons. The scene should feel quiet and cold before any light returns.
5. Group the two layers (Ctrl/Cmd+G) and name the group **MOOD**.

Action by action: real Photoshop screenshots (orange boxes show where to look), and the result

- 1 **Layer › New Adjustment Layer › Curves. Drag the middle of the line down.**

IN PHOTOSHOP



Boxes: the Curves line pulled down in Properties; the MOOD group with MOOD darken and the blue MOOD cool fill.

IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS

Before: the city as photographed



After: Curves darken + cool Soft Light fill



Before and after.



Left: the starting plate. Right: a Curves darken plus a cool Soft Light fill. Now there is room for the light to shine.

WHY

Light only reads as bright against darkness. Darkening first gives your light somewhere to go.

CHECK

The scene is clearly darker and cooler, the planned light area is still the lightest part, and the MOOD group can be switched off.

FIX

Everything muddy? Drag the top point of the curve back up slightly. Too blue? Lower the fill opacity.

Method basis: A1 · V3. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

04 Paint the light back in through a mask

Procedure status · partial application check. Original poster · Curves control checked in Photoshop 2026 on this Mac. The original mask construction was scripted; the full hand-painted reconstruction remains unverified. Full action coverage and the independent cold run remain pending.

DOCUMENT: LastLight_YourName.psd

SELECT: The area your light source should brighten

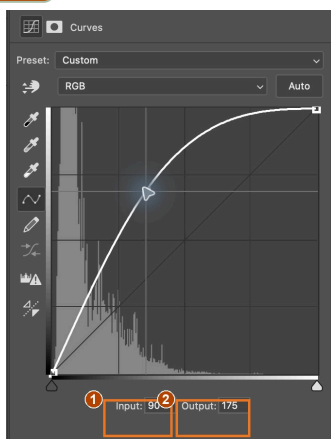
TOOLS / ROUTE: Curves · Ctrl/Cmd+I on the mask · Brush (B), soft, 10–20 % opacity

1. Add a Curves adjustment above MOOD named LIGHT paint. Set RGB points 0→0, 90→175 and 255→255. The original 90→175 point has been checked on screen.
2. Click its white mask thumbnail and press Ctrl/Cmd+I to invert it to black. The brightening disappears.
3. Choose the Brush (B): soft round, white, Opacity 10–20 %, Flow 100 %.
4. Start at your light source and paint outward in short strokes, building up light where it is strongest and letting it fade with distance.
5. Paint the light onto the surfaces you circled in your plan: the ground in front of the source, the side of the figure facing it.

Action by action: real Photoshop screenshots (orange boxes show where to look), and the result

- 1 Select LIGHT paint's adjustment thumbnail. Click the existing curve point and read Input 90 / Output 175. These lift dark midtones; the black mask controls where the lift appears.

IN PHOTOSHOP



1: Input 90. 2: Output 175 in the original LIGHT paint adjustment.

IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



Original scripted construction, before and after the light mask. The full manual painting sequence is not yet run to the same result.



Before and after painting light. It is brightest at the source and fades with distance, following the plan.

WHY

An inverted mask hides the adjustment everywhere, so you choose exactly where light lands. Low opacity lets you build it gradually, like real light falling off.

CHECK

The light is brightest at its source, falls off smoothly, and lands only on the surfaces the plan says it should.

FIX

Hard edges? Your brush hardness is above 0 %. Too strong? Paint black at low opacity to pull it back, or lower the layer opacity.

Method basis: A1 · A2 · V1 · V2. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

05 Read and shape the mask

Procedure status · partial application check. Original poster · Channels isolation and mask Properties were run in Photoshop 2026 on this Mac. Feather 30 px was applied to a separate repair copy; Density remains 100%. Full action coverage and the independent cold run remain pending.

DOCUMENT: LastLight_YourName.psd

SELECT: The LIGHT paint mask

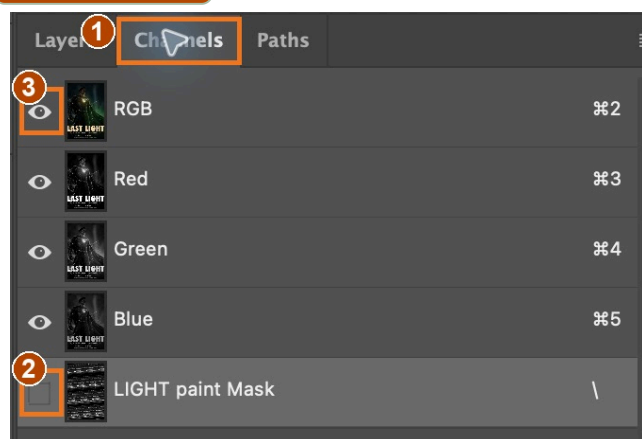
TOOLS / ROUTE: Channels › mask visibility / RGB visibility › Properties › Feather and Density

1. Click LIGHT paint's mask. Open Channels, turn the LIGHT paint Mask eye on, then turn the RGB eye off to read the mask alone.
2. Check the shape: it should be a soft pool that is brightest at the source and fades out, with no stripes or blotches.
3. Smooth stripes with a large soft brush at low opacity. Restore colour: turn the mask eye off, click RGB, then return to Layers.
4. With the mask selected, open Properties and set Feather to 30 px. Keep Density at 100%.
5. Keep mask Density at 100 %. Lower the LIGHT paint layer opacity to reduce the adjustment strength. Lower Density reveals the adjustment across hidden areas and can destroy the intended isolation. Save your file.

Action by action: real Photoshop screenshots (orange boxes show where to look), and the result

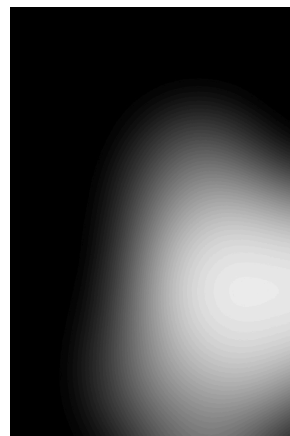
1 With LIGHT paint's mask selected, open Channels (1). Turn LIGHT paint Mask visibility on (2), then turn RGB visibility off (3). Read white as light revealed and black as light hidden.

IN PHOTOSHOP



1: Channels. 2: mask visibility. 3: RGB visibility. This is the verified alternative to Option-click.

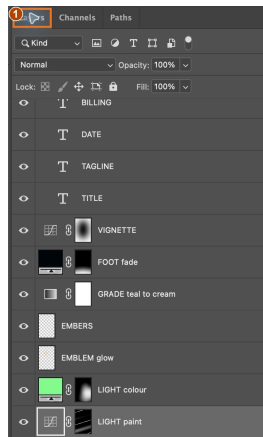
IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



The original light mask isolated in greyscale. The pool has a gradual fall-off.

2 To restore the image, turn the mask eye off, click the RGB channel row, and return to Layers. The colour poster should return.

IN PHOTOSHOP



1: Layers tab, after the RGB image was restored.

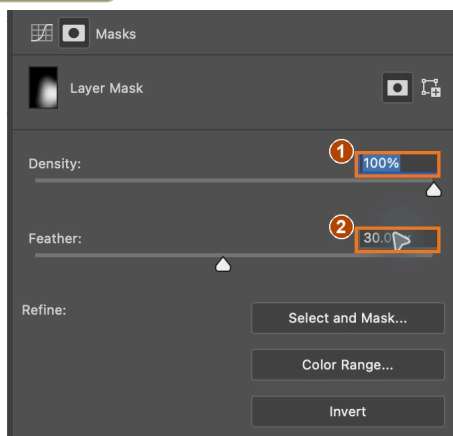
IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



The original poster returns with its lighting intact.

3 Click the mask thumbnail and open Properties. Keep Density at 100% (1). Enter Feather 30 px (2) to soften transitions without revealing the adjustment everywhere.

IN PHOTOSHOP



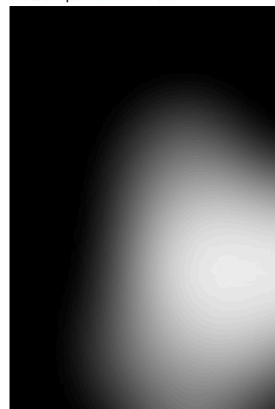
1: Density 100%. 2: Feather 30 px. Applied in the repair copy.

IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



The repaired copy preserves the original composition and blended lighting.

The LIGHT paint mask on its own



The result it produces



Left: the mask on its own; white is where the light lands. Right: the result it produces.

WHY

The mask is the light. Learning to read it tells you exactly why the image looks the way it does.

CHECK

A smooth mask with no stripes, brightest at the source, and a result that looks like light rather than paint.

FIX

Red overlay instead of greyscale? RGB is still visible: turn its eye off. To restore colour, hide the mask channel and click RGB. Feather unavailable? Select the mask thumbnail.

Method basis: [A2](#). Values and sequence are authored for this project.

SESSION B · LESSON 2 · MM12-26-S04-D02

Colour the light. Make the figure belong.

Real light has a colour and hits edges. Today the light gains colour, the figure catches it, and the air fills with glow.

06 Colour the green energy light

Recall first (from last lesson, no peeking):

1. What does “motivated light” mean?
2. Why darken the whole picture before adding any light?
3. What does an inverted (black) mask do to an adjustment layer?

Say or write your answers, then check them against your file.

Procedure status · partial application check. Original poster · the colour picker, Soft Light dropdown and layer opacity were inspected and the picker/dropdown confirmed in Photoshop 2026. The original mask was scripted; the complete copy-mask creation sequence is still pending. Full action coverage and the independent cold run remain pending.

DOCUMENT: LastLight_YourName.psd

SELECT: The green-lit area and the contrasting shadows

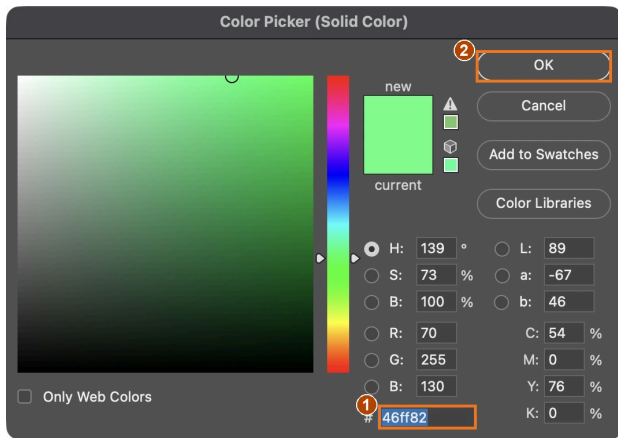
TOOLS / ROUTE: Solid Color fill · Soft Light · paste the light mask

1. Add a Solid Color fill layer in the demo green #46FF82 (RGB 70, 255, 130). Set it to Soft Light and name it **LIGHT colour**.
2. Alt/Option-drag the LIGHT paint mask onto LIGHT colour to copy it, so the colour lands only where the light does.
3. Set its layer opacity to 70 % for the demo. Adjust for your own source after comparing the result.
4. Compare the green-lit surfaces with the teal shadows. The later extension adds warm light; green is a stylised energy colour, not a physical colour-temperature measurement.
5. Write the hex codes of your light colour and shadow colour in your plan.

Action by action: real Photoshop screenshots (orange boxes show where to look), and the result

- 1 Double-click LIGHT colour's colour thumbnail. Enter #46FF82 (1), then click OK (2). The demonstrated RGB values are 70, 255, 130.

IN PHOTOSHOP



1: hexadecimal colour. 2: OK. This is the original layer's actual colour.

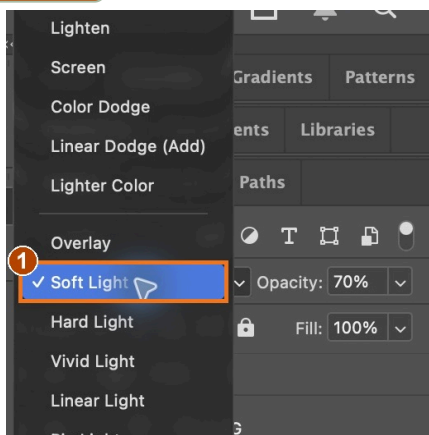
IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



Original scripted result comparison: neutral light becomes green reflected light.

- 2 With LIGHT colour selected, open the blend-mode dropdown and choose Soft Light (1). This blends colour into existing surfaces while preserving their texture.

IN PHOTOSHOP



The real dropdown is open; 1 boxes Soft Light.

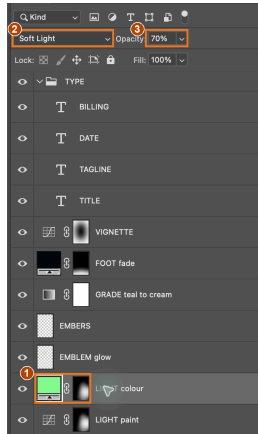
IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



Green light belongs to the right-facing cloth and armour; it does not obscure the subject as a flat painted patch.

3 Confirm **LIGHT** colour and its mask (1), **Soft Light** (2), and layer **Opacity 70%** (3). Compare the lit cape with the unlit left side.

IN PHOTOSHOP



1: **LIGHT** colour and mask. 2: **Soft Light**. 3: layer **Opacity 70%**.

IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



Texture and dark shadows remain readable under the light.

Blend-mode comparison · tested in the original PSD. I deliberately changed **LIGHT** colour from **Soft Light** to **Normal**, captured the result, then restored **Soft Light**. Colour **#46FF82**, the mask and **Opacity 70%** stayed the same. This isolates one variable; it is not an accidental build mistake or a complete reconstruction.



Wrong for this lighting: **Normal** covers the cloth and armour with green, weakening texture and shadow.



Intended result: **Soft Light** colours the existing illumination while keeping surfaces and shadows readable. Fix: choose **Soft Light**; do not add more green paint.



Before: neutral light. After: the same mask filled with green colour on Soft Light at 70 %.

WHY

Soft Light tints existing brightness and texture. Green against dark teal separates the illuminated surfaces; the later gold accents introduce a warm contrast.

CHECK

The lit area is green, and the unlit areas retain their grade, and the colour follows the light mask exactly.

FIX

Colour everywhere? The mask was not copied: Alt/Option-drag the mask thumbnail. Colour too strong? Lower layer opacity while leaving mask Density at 100 %.

Method basis: A3 · V3. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

07 Make the figure belong: match it and add a rim light

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: LastLight_YourName.psd

SELECT: The FIGURE layer and the edge that faces the light

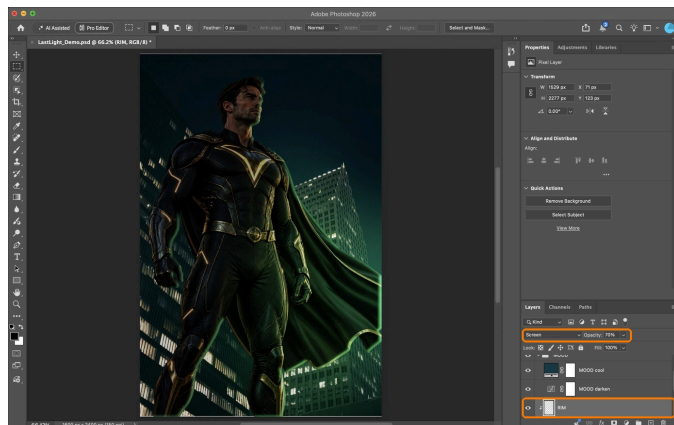
TOOLS / ROUTE: Clipped Curves · new layer, Color Dodge or Screen · soft brush

1. Add FIGURE darken directly above FIGURE: RGB 0→0, 128→74, 255→210. Clip it to FIGURE. These original values are scripted-reference values; full creation is not yet run manually.
2. Add an empty RIM layer above FIGURE darken and clip it to FIGURE. Use Screen, layer opacity 70%, and the original green #78FFA0 (RGB 120, 255, 160). The original edge selection was scripted; manual creation is not yet run.
3. Use a soft brush at low opacity to build a narrow rim on the edge facing the green source on the right. The original selection used a 16 px offset and 7 px blur; a matching manual brush width still needs to be tested.
4. Make the rim strongest where the edge turns most directly towards the light (forehead, nose, shoulder), and let it fade away round the back.
5. Before the later extension, check that each green highlight faces the primary blast on the right. Do not paint the entire outline equally.

Action by action: real Photoshop screenshots (orange boxes show where to look), and the result

- 1 Curves clipped to FIGURE to darken it; then a new clipped layer, RIM, painted along the edge that faces the light.

IN PHOTOSHOP



Boxes: RIM is set to Screen at 70 %; the small arrow beside its thumbnail means it is clipped to FIGURE.

IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS

Figure too bright for the scene



Darkened to match, green rim on the side facing the blast



Before and after: the hero now sits in the night, with a green edge on the blast side only.

Earlier scripted-demo author note · before/after mistake evidence not retained: our first rim was set to Color Dodge and was invisible on the darkened figure: Color Dodge needs something bright underneath. Screen fixed it. The second try glowed outside the body because the layer had come unclipped: check for the small clipping arrow.



After matching the figure's darkness, a rim light traces only the edge that faces the glow.

WHY

A rim light separates the figure from the background and proves which way the light comes from. Light on the wrong side is the first thing viewers notice as fake.

CHECK

The figure is as dark as its surroundings, and a thin green rim appears only on the side facing the source.

FIX

Rim spilling past the edge? It must be clipped: Alt/Option-click between RIM and FIGURE. Glowing like neon? Lower RIM opacity or use Screen instead of Color Dodge.

Method basis: A3 · V2 · V4. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

08 Fill the air: glow, rays and haze

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: LastLight_YourName.psd

SELECT: The air around the light source

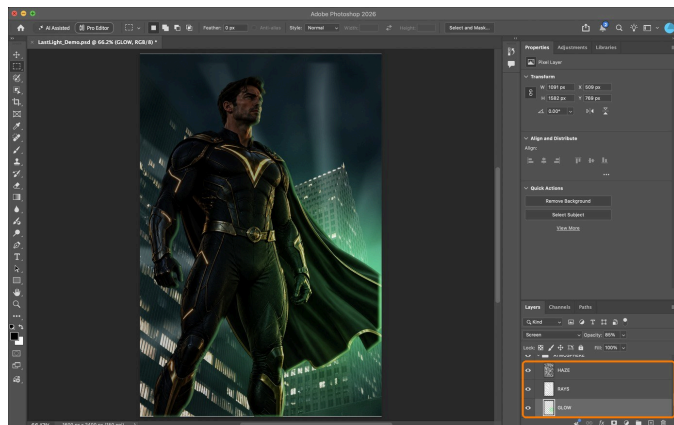
TOOLS / ROUTE: Radial gradient on Screen · Filter › Blur › Radial Blur (Zoom) · Filter › Render › Clouds

1. Glow: add GLOW above PLATE and below FIGURE, Screen at 85%. Centre it near X 1300, Y 1560. The original scripted source uses #28E66E for the broad halo and #D7FFE1 for its core; a matching manual gradient is not yet run.
2. Rays: on RAYS, build strokes spreading from that source. Use Filter › Blur › Radial Blur, Zoom, Amount 100, Quality Good, with the blur centre at the source; then Gaussian Blur 8 px. Use Screen at 40%. Original ray shapes were scripted; this manual route is not yet run.
3. Haze: add HAZE, reset foreground/background with D, then Filter › Render › Clouds and Gaussian Blur 30 px. Use Screen at 20%. Keep it below FIGURE. This full creation route is not yet run manually.
4. Keep GLOW, RAYS and HAZE above PLATE and below FIGURE, grouped as ATMOSPHERE. The figure must occlude the source behind it. No atmospheric layer should become brighter than the source.
5. Group them as ATMOSPHERE. Toggle the group to check it helps and does not wash out the image.

Action by action: real Photoshop screenshots (orange boxes show where to look), and the result

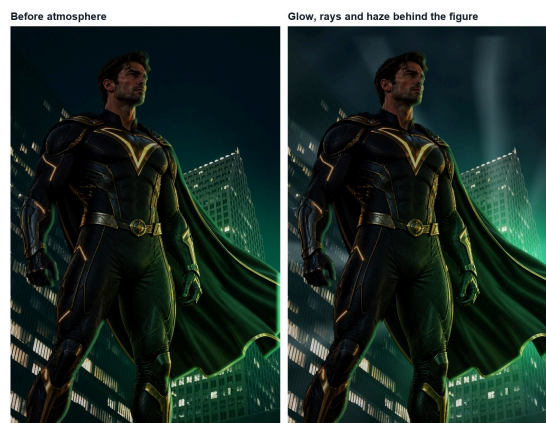
- 1 Three layers on Screen, between the plate and the figure, grouped as ATMOSPHERE.

IN PHOTOSHOP

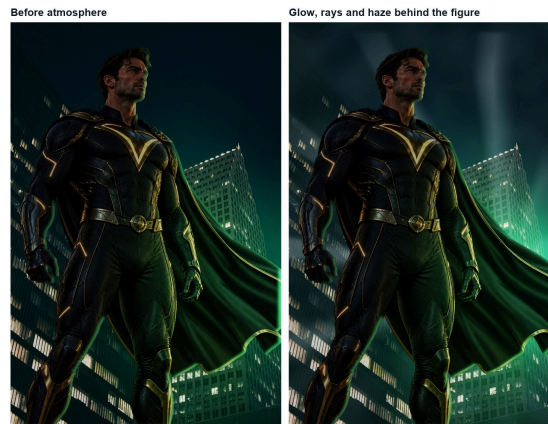


Box: HAZE, RAYS and GLOW inside the ATMOSPHERE group.

IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



Before and after.



Before and after adding glow, rays and haze. The air now shows where the light is travelling.

WHY

Light is only visible in the air when something (fog, dust, smoke) catches it. Adding it makes the light feel physical and pulls the eye to the source.

CHECK

A glow around the source, rays that spread from it, haze that thickens with distance, and the figure still readable.

FIX

Rays point the wrong way? Undo the Radial Blur and set its centre on the source. Everything grey? Lower the haze opacity or mask it more.

Method basis: A3 · V3. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

09 Unify it with a colour grade and vignette

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: LastLight_YourName.psd

SELECT: Everything (top of the stack)

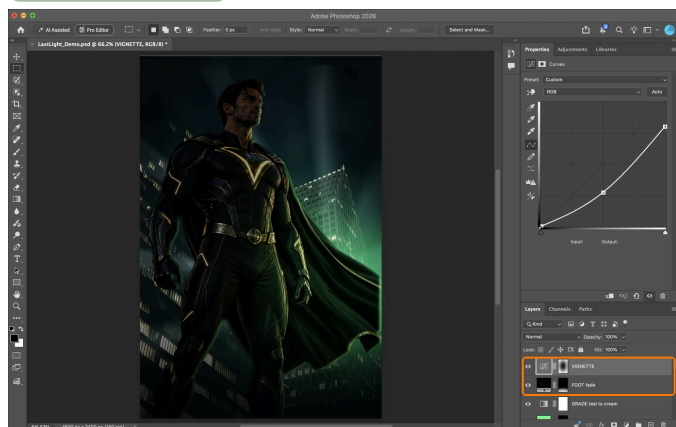
TOOLS / ROUTE: Gradient Map · Color Lookup · Curves vignette

1. Add the original Gradient Map: 0% #06282E to 100% #E6FFD7, Soft Light, Opacity 32%. These values come from the original demo script; this full route is not yet run manually.
2. Add VIGNETTE with RGB curve points 0→0, 128→70, 255→205. Keep its mask white at the outer edges and paint black softly over the subject. This original exact curve is not yet run manually.
3. Toggle VIGNETTE. It should guide attention without a visible ring or hiding story information; refine that same mask rather than adding a second vignette.
4. Compare against your plan: is the brightest point still the light source? Is the figure's face or silhouette still clear?
5. Save a flattened JPG copy as LastLight_YourName_keyart.jpg (File › Export › Export As) before you add type.

Action by action: real Photoshop screenshots (orange boxes show where to look), and the result

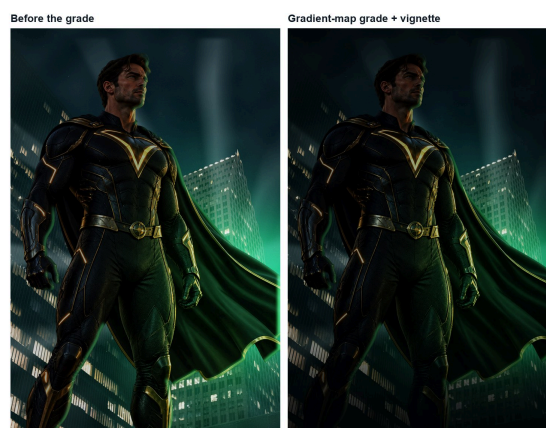
- 1 **Original Gradient Map #06282E to #E6FFD7 on Soft Light at 32%, then VIGNETTE Curves with the centre of its mask painted black. This earlier scripted capture does not prove the manual creation route.**

IN PHOTOSHOP

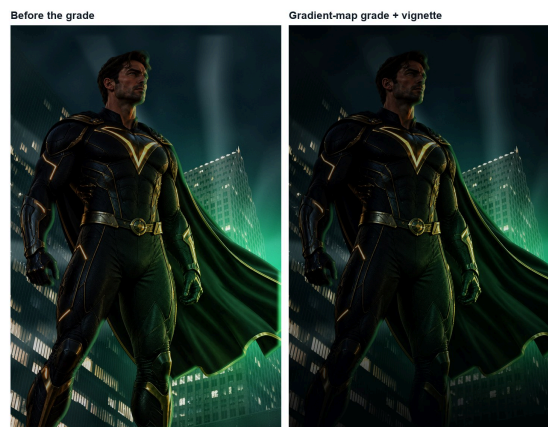


Box: VIGNETTE (note its mask: black in the middle) above GRADE.

IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



Before and after.



Before and after a gradient-map grade and vignette. One colour story across the whole poster.

WHY

A grade ties the plate, figure and effects into one colour world. A vignette keeps the eye inside the frame and on the light.

CHECK

One consistent colour mood, darker corners, and the light source still the brightest point.

FIX

Faces look strange? Lower the Gradient Map opacity or mask it off skin. Vignette ringed? Use a bigger, softer brush.

Method basis: A1. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

SESSION C · LESSON 3 · MM12-26-S04-D03

Pro lighting: relight, glow and light wrap.

This is the level of the Spider-Man and high-end ad posters: a subject shot in flat light, relit by two coloured sources and a glowing object in the frame. You learn each move from the professionals, then apply it to your own key art.

10 Read the reference and add a weaker contrasting rim

Recall first (from last lesson, no peeking):

1. What colour were your light and your shadows, and why?
2. Which edge of the figure gets the rim light?
3. What does clipping a layer to FIGURE do?

Say or write your answers, then check them against your file.

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: LastLight_YourName.psd · your FIGURE layer (the class hero has soft, even light)

SELECT: FIGURE clipping stack; the far edge facing a planned weaker off-screen source

TOOLS / ROUTE: Reference analysis · clipped paint layer · Screen

1. Inspect the original poster and an approved professional reference. Label the primary green blast, weaker warm source from the opposite side, and small warm chest emitter. Explain which surfaces each can reach.
2. Above the existing clipped RIM, add an empty layer named RIM secondary and clip it to FIGURE. Original script name: RIM cool, despite its gold colour. Keep this naming difference explicit.
3. Set Screen, layer opacity 80%, colour #FFBE5A (RGB 255, 190, 90). Paint a restrained highlight on the opposite edge with a soft brush at 10%; judge width at output size.
4. Toggle the new rim. It should provide separation without erasing the green side or making the whole outline neon. Full manual painting is not yet run; the original uses a scripted edge selection.
5. Compare two genuine other people's posters. Record maker/date/source, visible form/content, a sourced historical or cultural fact, and a qualified emotional interpretation for each.

Watch the technique, then apply it to your poster:

- Spider-Man poster design (Nour Art): identify every light source and its colour
- How to add light using dodge and burn (PiXimperfect): painting light through Curves masks
- Realistic highlights (Benny Productions): where highlights land on a face



The class hero before any lighting: soft, even light. That is ideal for relighting, because you add every highlight on purpose.

WHY

Additional sources must be planned and consistent. A weaker contrasting rim can separate the far edge while preserving the main source's direction.

CHECK

The green primary light remains dominant across broad surfaces; the warm secondary rim is narrow and motivated. Submit the sourced two-image comparison for 1.2.

FIX

Whole outline bright? Restrict the secondary rim to its facing edge. A rim outside the body indicates a clipping or mask problem.

Method basis: **V4** · **V6** · **V2**. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

11 Put a glowing object in the frame and let it light the subject

Procedure status · partial application check. Original poster · EMBLEM glow's actual Linear Dodge (Add) / 100% state was inspected. Painting the glow and cast-light masks manually to match this image is not yet run. Full action coverage and the independent cold run remain pending.

DOCUMENT: LastLight_YourName.psd · FIGURE clipping stack and chest emblem

SELECT: Chest emblem around X 730, Y 728 and the nearby chest/jaw surfaces

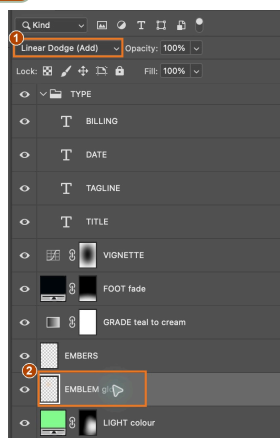
TOOLS / ROUTE: Clipped Curves mask · soft paint · Linear Dodge (Add)

1. Above the figure clipping stack, add EMBLEM cast, clip it to FIGURE, and set RGB 0→0, 100→180, 255→255. Invert its mask to black.
2. With a soft white brush at 10%, reveal light on nearby chest planes and the underside of the jaw. The source is the chest, not an object in the hand.
3. Add EMBLEM glow below the final grade. Set Linear Dodge (Add), layer opacity 100%. Centre its paint near X 730, Y 728.
4. Paint a broad #FFAA3C halo at 30% brush opacity and a smaller #FFE196 core at 70%. Original scripted halo radius 230/feather110; core radius60×70/feather26. The soft-brush match remains not yet run.
5. Toggle glow and cast separately. The emitter needs both a visible core and illumination on nearby surfaces. A larger halo alone cannot make it belong.

Action by action: real Photoshop screenshots (orange boxes show where to look), and the result

- 1 Select EMBLEM glow (2). Its blend mode is Linear Dodge (Add) (1), with layer Opacity 100%. The warm source must also brighten the chest and underside of the jaw through the separate EMBLEM cast mask.

IN PHOTOSHOP



1: Linear Dodge (Add). 2: EMBLEM glow. The layer was created in the original scripted demo.

IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



A gold source on the chest lights nearby surfaces. A larger halo alone cannot replace cast light.

Watch the technique, then apply it to your poster:

- How to create a glow effect (Adobe Photoshop / Benny): building the glow and halo
- How to glow anything (Webflippy): making an object glow and spill light onto nearby surfaces
- Stylish highlights (Benny Productions): coloured highlight painting



Reference plate (CC0): a real handheld light. Notice the bright, warm fall-off on the fingers and the darkness just beyond. Your cast light must match this.

WHY

An emitter illuminates nearby surfaces as well as itself. Cast light makes the chest glow feel embedded in the scene.

CHECK

Small warm chest core, wider restrained halo, and cast illumination on nearby chest and jaw; broad green lighting stays readable.

FIX

Sticker-like glow? Compare nearby surfaces with glow hidden and visible; inspect the cast mask and its clipping before enlarging the halo.

Method basis: V7 · V8 · V1. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

12 Blend the edges with light wrap, add particles and grade

Procedure status · partial application check. Original poster · the existing LIGHT WRAP Smart Filter was opened and Gaussian Blur 30 px confirmed in Photoshop 2026. Its Screen / 55% state was checked. Creation of the duplicate, clipping and new mask from scratch is not yet run. Full action coverage and the independent cold run remain pending.

DOCUMENT: LastLight_YourName.psd

SELECT: The subject's edges and the air around the light

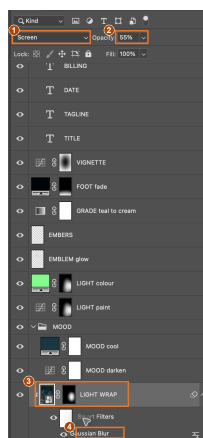
TOOLS / ROUTE: Duplicate PLATE · Smart Object · Gaussian Blur · clipping mask · Screen · particle brush · Gradient Map

1. Light wrap creation (not yet run from scratch): duplicate PLATE to LIGHT WRAP above the FIGURE clipping stack; keep it a Smart Object and clip it to FIGURE. Apply Gaussian Blur 30 px, Screen, Opacity 55%. Add a black mask and reveal only edges facing bright background areas. The existing original filter and blend settings were checked; the full duplication/clipping/masking route remains unverified.
2. Particles: add EMBERS, Color Dodge at 90%. The original uses #96FFAA particles with varied opacity and Gaussian Blur 1.5 px, constructed by script. A matching manual scatter-brush setup and action captures are not yet run.
3. Depth: blur the particles nearest the camera more than the ones near the subject.
4. Original grade: Gradient Map from #06282E (RGB 6, 40, 46) at 0% to #E6FFD7 (230, 255, 215) at 100%, Soft Light at 32%. Keep the chest emblem brightest. Creation of this exact grade remains not yet run manually.
5. Export the finished key art. Compare side by side with the Nour Art or Mir Rom final: name one thing yours does as well and one thing to improve.

Action by action: real Photoshop screenshots (orange boxes show where to look), and the result

1 Select LIGHT WRAP (3). The actual original uses a duplicated PLATE Smart Object clipped into the figure stack, Screen (1), Opacity 55% (2), and a mostly black mask. Double-click Gaussian Blur (4) under Smart Filters.

IN PHOTOSHOP



1: Screen. 2: 55%. 3: clipped LIGHT WRAP Smart Object and mask. 4: Gaussian Blur.

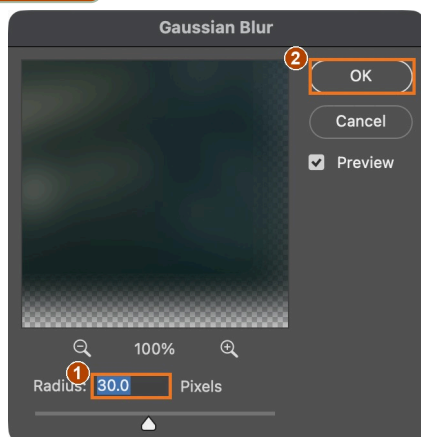
IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



Background light subtly overlaps facing edges while the figure remains visible.

2 In Gaussian Blur, set Radius 30 pixels (1), keep Preview on and click OK (2). Restrict the wrap with its mask; do not soften the entire hero.

IN PHOTOSHOP



1: 30 px. 2: OK. This filter dialog was actually opened and confirmed.

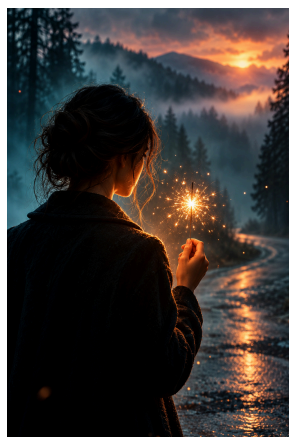
IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



The original hero remains sharp; the background copy supplies soft edge light.

Watch the technique, then apply it to your poster:

- High-end advertising posters (Nour Art): finishing passes: light wrap, particles, grade
- Cinematic movie poster (Mir Rom): atmosphere and final grade
- Master shadows and lighting in compositing (PiXimperfect): matching light and colour so the subject belongs



Exemplar concept art (AI-generated, labelled): the pro-level finish to aim for. Your poster is built in Photoshop.

WHY

Light wrap is how compositors make a subject sit inside a bright scene instead of on top of it. Particles show the air the light travels through. The grade ties it together.

CHECK

Edges that pick up the background light, particles concentrated in the light beam with depth, and a unified grade with the glowing object brightest.

FIX

Light wrap glows all round the subject? Mask it to the edges that face bright areas only. Particles look flat? Vary size and blur, and keep most of them in the light.

Method basis: V4 · V9 · V3. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

SESSION D · LESSON 4 · MM12-26-S04-D04

Type it. Move the light. Make it move.

A poster needs type that fits its light. Then the real test: your director wants the light on the other side, and you have one period.

13 Set the poster type

Recall first (from last lesson, no peeking):

1. Locate the green blast, weaker opposite rim source and warm chest emitter. Which surfaces does each affect?
2. What is light wrap for?
3. Why can a small bright emblem coexist with a primary blast lighting broad surfaces?

Say or write your answers, then check them against your file.

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: LastLight_YourName.psd

SELECT: Title, tagline, billing block, date

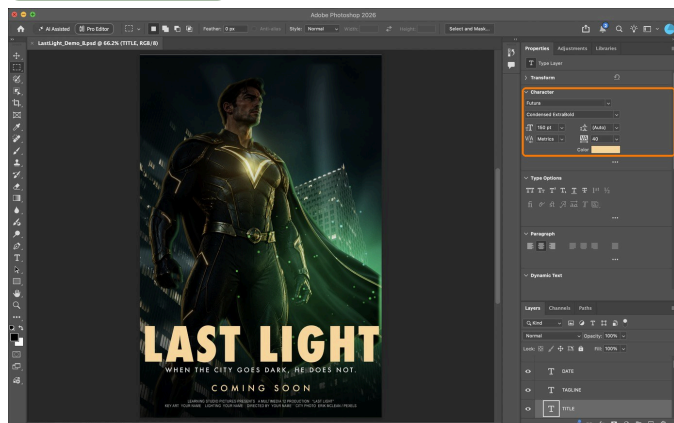
TOOLS / ROUTE: Type tool (T) · Character panel · Align

1. Title: select Type (T). The original uses Futura Condensed ExtraBold, 150 pt, #FFD696, tracking 40, centred at X 800 with baseline Y 2030. This exact manual type route is not yet run; the original was scripted.
2. Tagline: Futura Medium, 20 pt, #EBEBEB, tracking 240; centre X 800, baseline Y 2100. Preserve space between title and tagline.
3. Date: Futura Medium, 26 pt, #FFD696, tracking 400; centre X 800, baseline Y 2225. Billing: Arial Narrow, 12 pt, #C8C8C8, tracking 40; centre X 800, baseline Y 2300.
4. Use your own film title, tagline and fictional credits. These installed fonts are demo references; choose a school-available licensed substitute if unavailable. Font binaries are not included.
5. View at intended output size. Check reading order, contrast and space around the face/light, then save. Manual type construction and a matching fresh result remain pending.

Action by action: real Photoshop screenshots (orange boxes show where to look), and the result

- 1 Type tool (T): title, tagline, date and billing block, centred on one line.

IN PHOTOSHOP



IT SHOULD LOOK LIKE THIS



Box: the Character settings for the title (Futura Condensed ExtraBold, 150 pt, colour sampled from the light).

What each piece of type is for.



Poster anatomy: title, tagline, key art, light source, billing block and date, each with one job.

WHY

Poster type follows a hierarchy readers expect: title first, tagline second, credits last. Type in the light's colour makes it feel part of the same world.

CHECK

Four type elements in clear order of size, aligned, in two typefaces at most, and none covering the light or the face.

FIX

Title hard to read? Add a subtle dark Curves behind it, masked to the title area. Billing block too wide? Reduce tracking or font size, not the letter width.

Method basis: S2 · V5. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

14 Practical check: move the light

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: LastLight_YourName.psd · the director's note

SELECT: Your editable poster and assigned director card

TOOLS / ROUTE: Independent decisions using taught tools

1. Save a separate version and export poster A before making changes.
2. Your teacher assigns one of the four director cards in the downloaded template. State the changed requirement and predict its effect on the image.
3. Plan and make your own response. Keep the original film, intended audience and editable source file.
4. Compare A and B against the assigned card at the intended viewing size. Record one observed mismatch, your revision and its result.
5. Export poster B and submit A, B, the layered PSD and a brief defence of two decisions, one trade-off and one remaining limitation.

Independent evidence: no model answer is supplied. Your teacher assesses the response to your assigned card, the editable controls and your reasoning.

WHY

A changed requirement tests whether you can transfer the lighting ideas to a new situation.

CHECK

The revised image meets the assigned card, preserves the film and audience, and has coherent motivated lighting. You can locate and defend the relevant editable controls.

FIX

Restate the requirement and compare it with your result. Describe the mismatch before choosing a control. The Coach may explain terminology; the assessed edits are your decisions.

Method basis: A2. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

15 Make the light move: a 5-second teaser

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: LastLight_YourName.psd

SELECT: LIGHT paint, ATMOSPHERE and RIM

TOOLS / ROUTE: Window › Timeline · Create Video Timeline · Opacity keyframes · Render Video

1. Choose Window › Timeline and click *Create Video Timeline*. Set the length to 5 seconds (drag the end of the work area).
2. Open the LIGHT paint layer's track, click the stopwatch next to Opacity, and set keyframes: 0 % at 0 s, 100 % at 2 s.
3. Add a flicker or breathing light: a few quick opacity keyframes on ATMOSPHERE (for example 60 %, 90 %, 70 %) between 2 s and 4 s.
4. Fade the title in from 0 % to 100 % between 3 s and 4 s. Hold the full poster to 5 s.
5. Choose File › Export › Render Video, H.264, 1080 × 1620, and save LastLight_YourName_teaser.mp4. Hand in A, B, the teaser, the PSD and your explanation.

WHY

Film posters now run as motion posters on social media and in cinemas. Because your light is on its own layers, you can animate it without redrawing anything.

CHECK

A 5-second MP4 where the light fades up, the atmosphere flickers, and the title appears, plus all hand-in files.

FIX

No Timeline panel? Choose Window › Timeline. Render too slow? Use 720 × 1080. Keyframes not saving? Click the stopwatch first.

Method basis: A4. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

Student QA.

- ☐ My poster has a believable primary source; every highlight agrees with an identified source.
- ☐ My light is on adjustment layers with masks, not painted on the photo.
- ☐ The rim light is only on the edge facing the source.
- ☐ Type has a clear hierarchy and stays off the light and the face.
- ☐ Poster B meets my assigned director card with coherent lighting.
- ☐ My film, title and credits are original, and I have permission for any classmate photo.

Copy a focused Coach context

Guided work: explain a tool, ask a diagnostic question or suggest a check. Independent practical: explain terminology only; do not choose edits or provide a model answer. Do not paste personal information.

Context to copy

Multimedia 12 • mm12-26-s04 • last-light

My current step: ____

My intended result: ____

What I see instead: ____

One change I tried: ____

Is this the independent practical? ____

Explain the relevant term and ask me a diagnostic question. Do not decide my assessed edits.

EVIDENCE CONVERSATION

Keep it short and specific.

What is your light source, and why is it believable in this scene?

Which layer made the biggest difference, and what does its mask look like?

Which layers did you change to move the light, and why those?

How do the light colour and shadow colour support your story?

What does your 5-second teaser add that the still poster cannot?

SOURCES AND AUTHORSHIP

Method references.

A1 Adobe. Adjustment and fill layers. <https://helpx.adobe.com/photoshop/using/adjustment-fill-layers.html>

A2 Adobe. Mask layers (layer masks, invert, Properties panel). <https://helpx.adobe.com/photoshop/using/masking-layers.html>

A3 Adobe. Blending modes (Soft Light, Screen, Color Dodge, Overlay). <https://helpx.adobe.com/photoshop/using/blending-modes.html>

A4 Adobe. Create timeline animations. <https://helpx.adobe.com/photoshop/using/creating-timeline-animations.html>

S1 StudioBinder. What is motivated lighting in film. <https://www.studiobinder.com/blog/what-is-motivated-lighting-in-film/>

S2 Posterwire. Credit where credit is due: the movie-poster billing block. <https://posterwire.com/poster-credits-font/>

V1 Benny Productions. How to create stylish highlights in Photoshop (YouTube). https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yUPiChL7_x8

V2 Benny Productions. How to add realistic highlights in Photoshop (YouTube). <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ORUoAVxXsY>

V3 Mir Rom. Creating a cinematic movie poster in Photoshop (YouTube). <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t71VO6tBqY8>

V4 Nour Art. Spider-Man poster manipulation (YouTube) — technique only; characters are someone else's property. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b1QoecESJJE>

V5 Hazy Graphix. Avengers poster remake (YouTube) — title and layout only. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-zyM37IWSnk>

V6 PiXimperfect. How to add light in Photoshop using dodge and burn (YouTube). <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbwlLjx83rg>

V7 Adobe Photoshop (Benny). How to create a glow effect (YouTube). <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ENCMGabrOcY>

V8 Webflippy. How to glow anything in Photoshop (YouTube). <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mQSKseBIA4c>

V9 PiXimperfect. Master shadows and lighting in compositing (YouTube). <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Da4axkDKzxQ>

Photo credits

Misty road by a forest (Unsplash).jpg · Bara Cross baracross · CC0 · [source](#). Processed as stated in each caption.

Stars Flashlight Cajon Pass (Unsplash).jpg · Jeremy Bishop tidesinourveins · CC0 · [source](#). Processed as stated in each caption.

Sparkler@TraphillNC.jpg · Kelley Bozarth · CC0 · [source](#). Processed as stated in each caption.

Fearless male in medical uniform and superhero costume · Klaus Nielsen · Pexels licence (free to use and modify) · [source](#). Processed as stated in each caption.

View rendered from the German Town Street HDRI · Poly Haven · CC0 · [source](#). Processed as stated in each caption.

Figures marked Illustration are drawn, not screenshots. Step values are starting points authored for this project. Draft for teacher review; not yet classroom-piloted.

Last Light v2 (superhero poster, 4 Oct 2026) · MM12 Sprint 4 (lessons d01–d04) · LAST LIGHT is a fictional demonstration film. Screenshots are real Photoshop 2026. The demo PSD was assembled by script using the same layers, blend modes and masks the steps teach; the masks were made with feathered selections where students use a soft brush. New 9 October captures inspect the original layered poster in Photoshop 2026 on this Mac: Curves 90→175, mask isolation, Density 100% / Feather 30 px, #46FF82, the open Soft Light dropdown / 70%, and the existing LIGHT WRAP Gaussian Blur 30 px / Screen 55%. These are partial control checks, not a completed manual reconstruction. The rejected green-patch rebuild is excluded. AppleScript opened the existing PSD; native UI controls were inspected and confirmed. Earlier scripted reference construction remains disclosed. City photo: Erik Mclean, Pexels. Hero image supplied by the teacher (classroom use only). Fresh author run on 9 October: new document, city placement, naming and flip were performed through native controls; five action captures are included. Full edge coverage, figure reconstruction and save/reopen remain pending after the Mac locked. No construction script was used in this fresh portion. Not yet cold-run. Draft for teacher review. Repair edition 9 October 2026; manual end-to-end Photoshop test, action captures, genuine mistake pairs, motion-render QA and independent cold run pending.